

Game Design is Experience Design

無涖 | PWE

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Before We Begin

This is a Discussion

- ✓ Personal thoughts
- ✗ Right answer
- ✗ The only answer

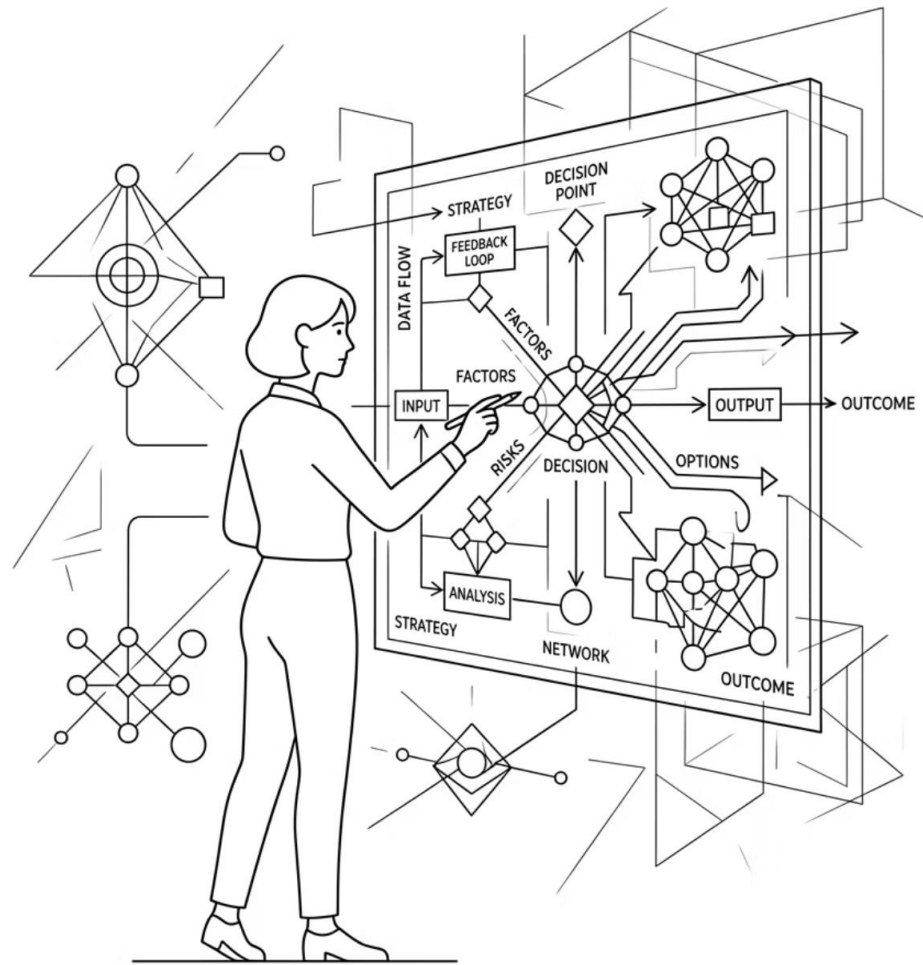
Interrupt Freely

- ✓ Ask if have any doubts
- ✓ Spark ideas for everyone

The Goal

- ✗ Get something
- ✓ Think in your own way

What You'll Walk Away With



A Thinking Framework

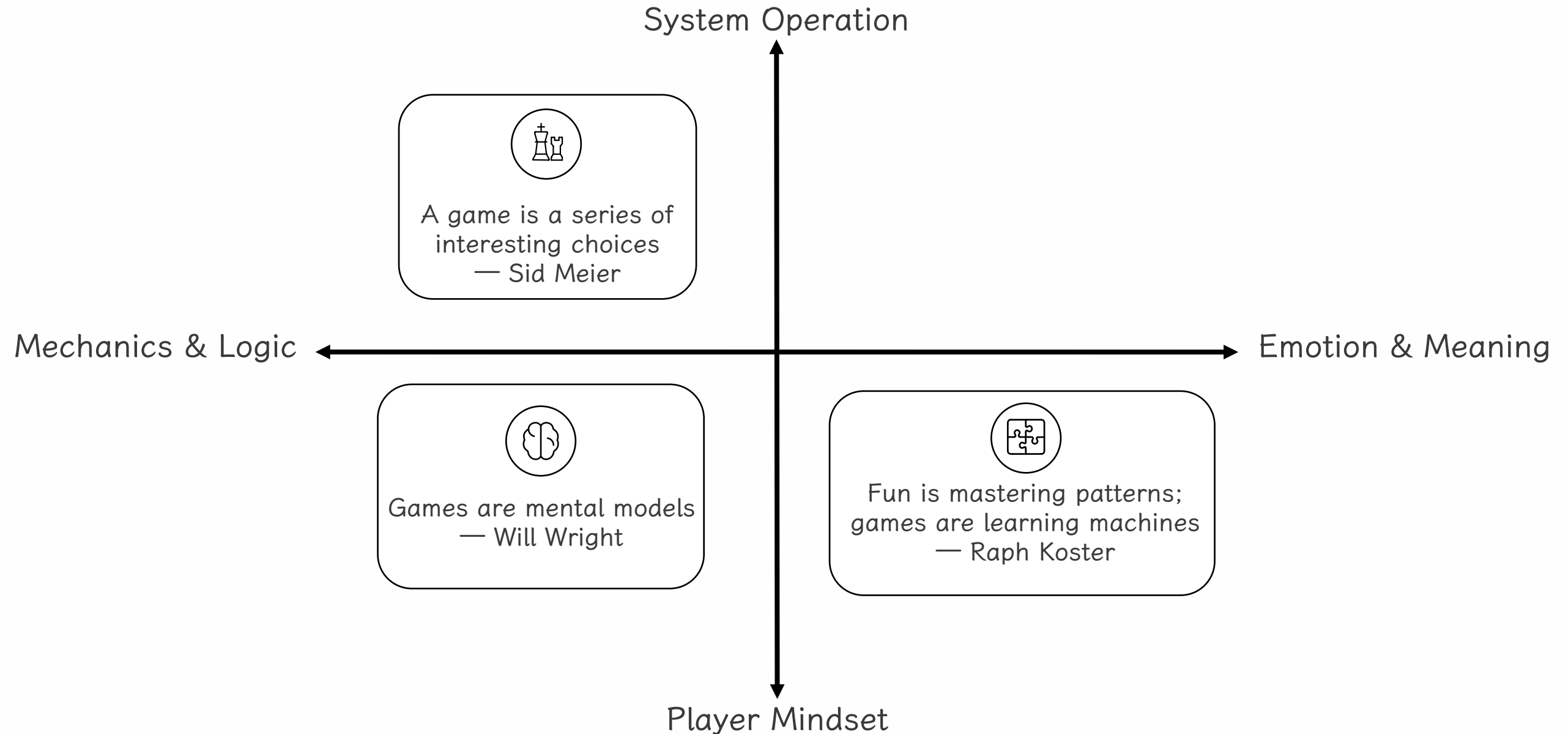
How design choices in games are made
— and why they make you feel what you feel.

Not a recipe. A way of seeing.

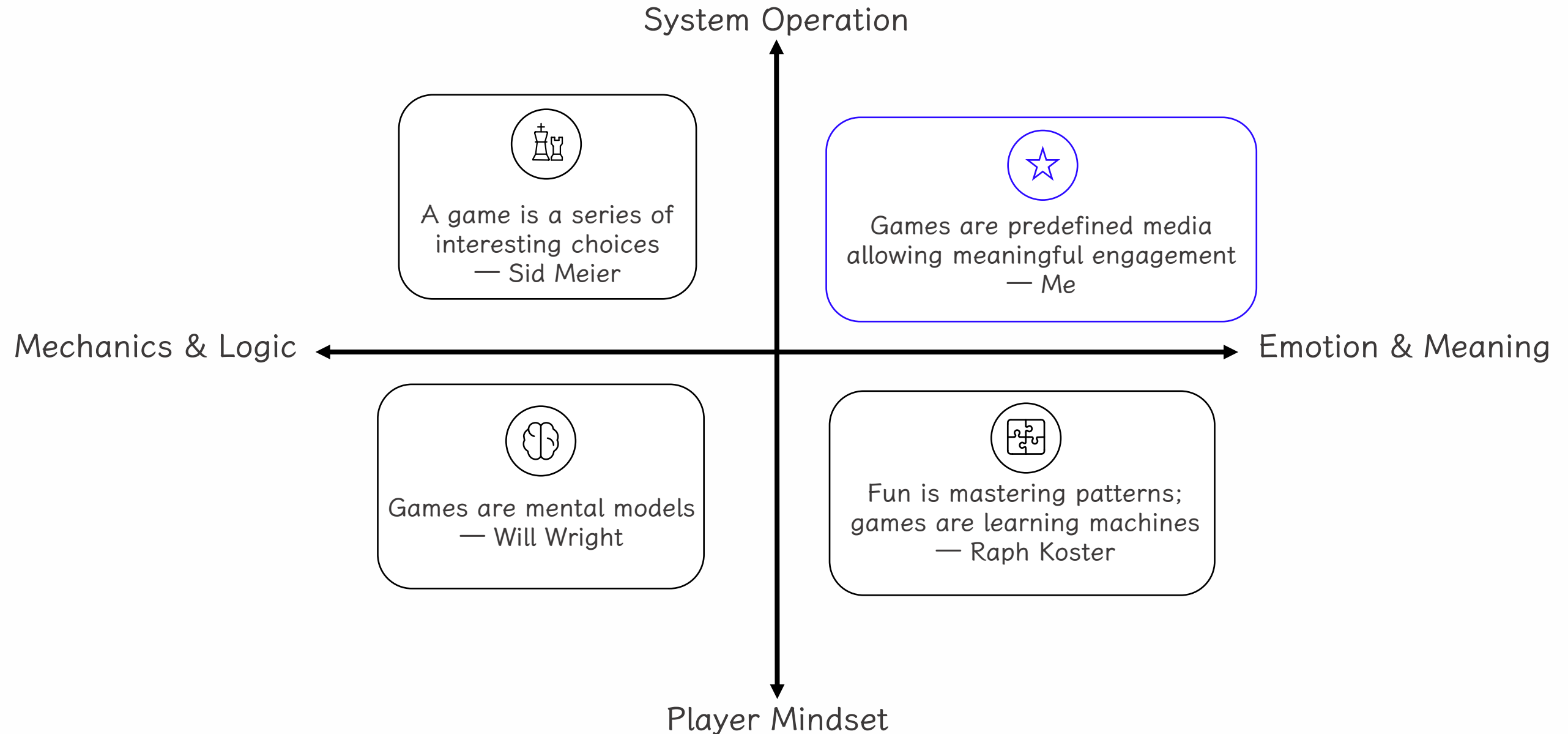
What Are Games?

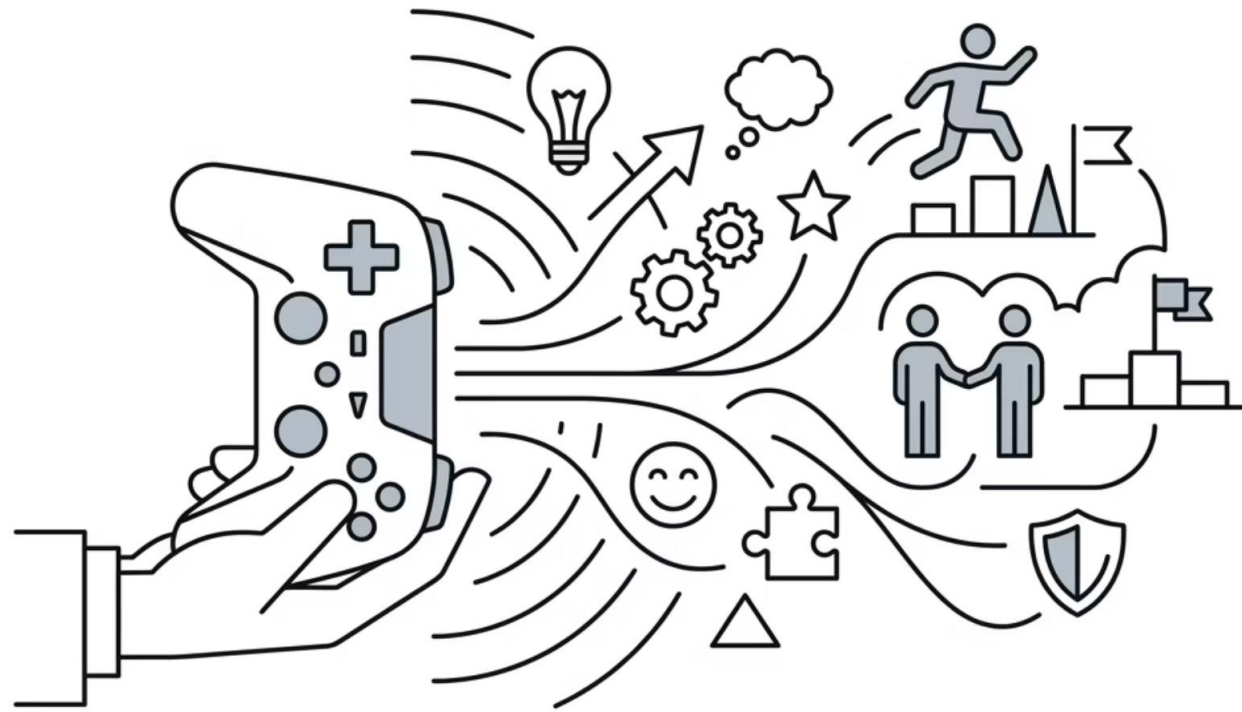
What Are Games?

Great thinkers have answered this differently. Each definition reveals something true.



What Are Games?





What Is Game Design?

| "Game design is [experience design](#)."

— Jesse Schell & David M.

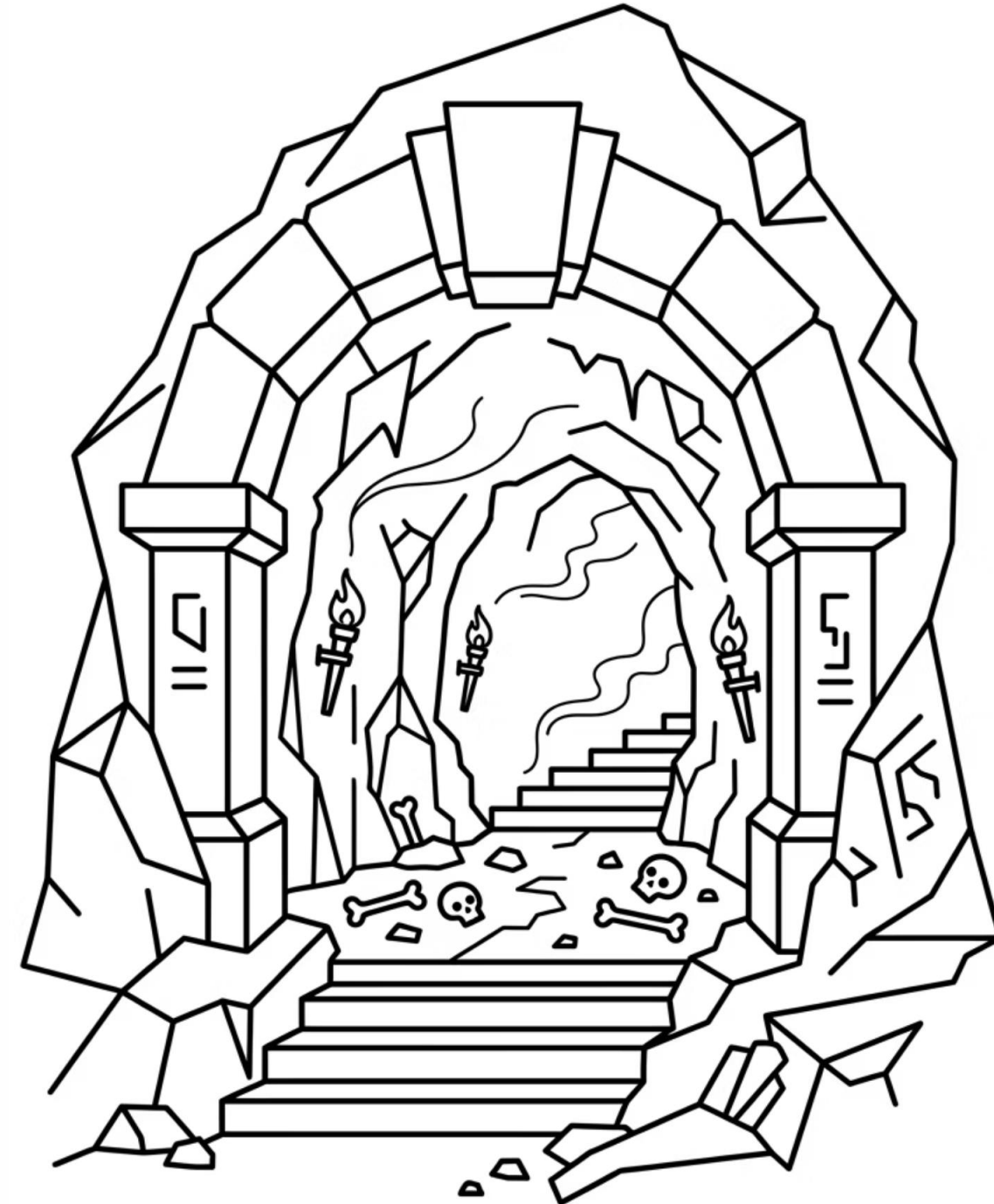
Not just mechanics, rules, or systems. At its heart,
game design is the craft of **shaping how someone feels**.

Case Study:

Dark Souls — Tomb of the Giants

Let's watch a 5-minute playthrough together.

Just experience it first. Don't analyze yet.





Tear-down the Experiences

 Did you feel anything?

 What specifically?

 Why did you feel it?

Did You Feel Anything?



Disorientation

You can't see.

Your map instincts fail you.



Fear

Something is out there.

You feel it before you see it.



Vulnerability

Powerlessness in a world that doesn't
care about you.

The Deeper Question

Why Do You Feel It?

The emotion doesn't come from nowhere.
It resonates with something **already** inside you.

Personal Memory

Darkness you've experienced before

Imagination

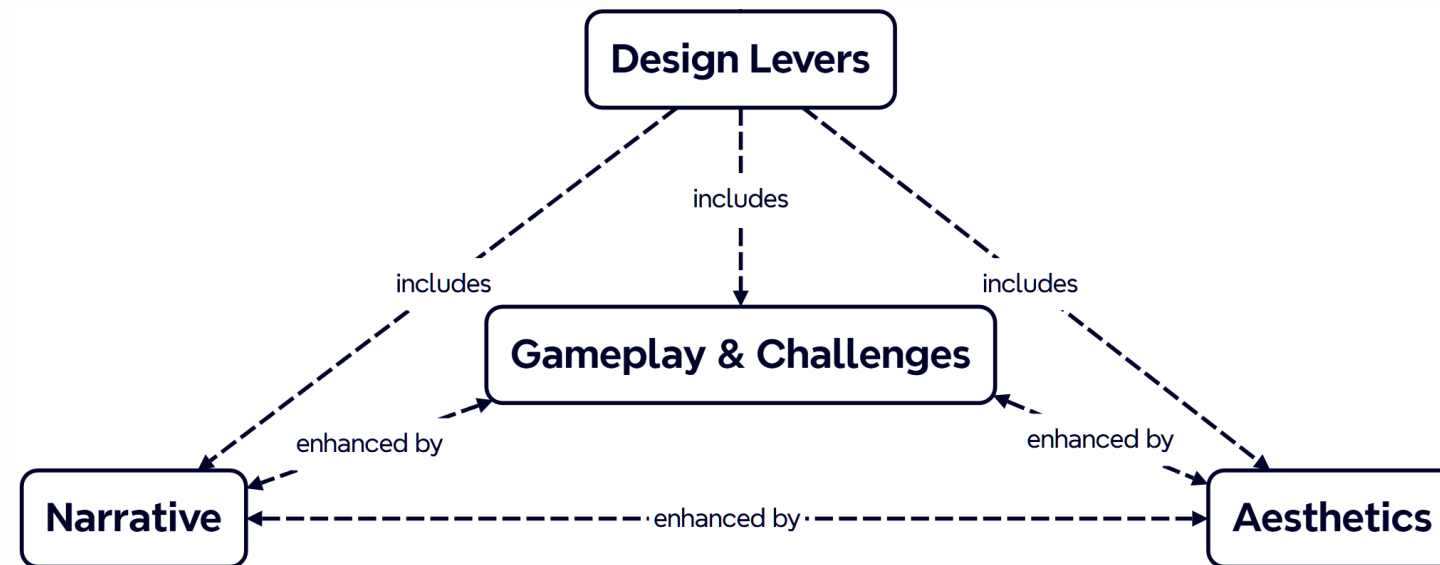
What might be lurking just beyond sight

Resonance

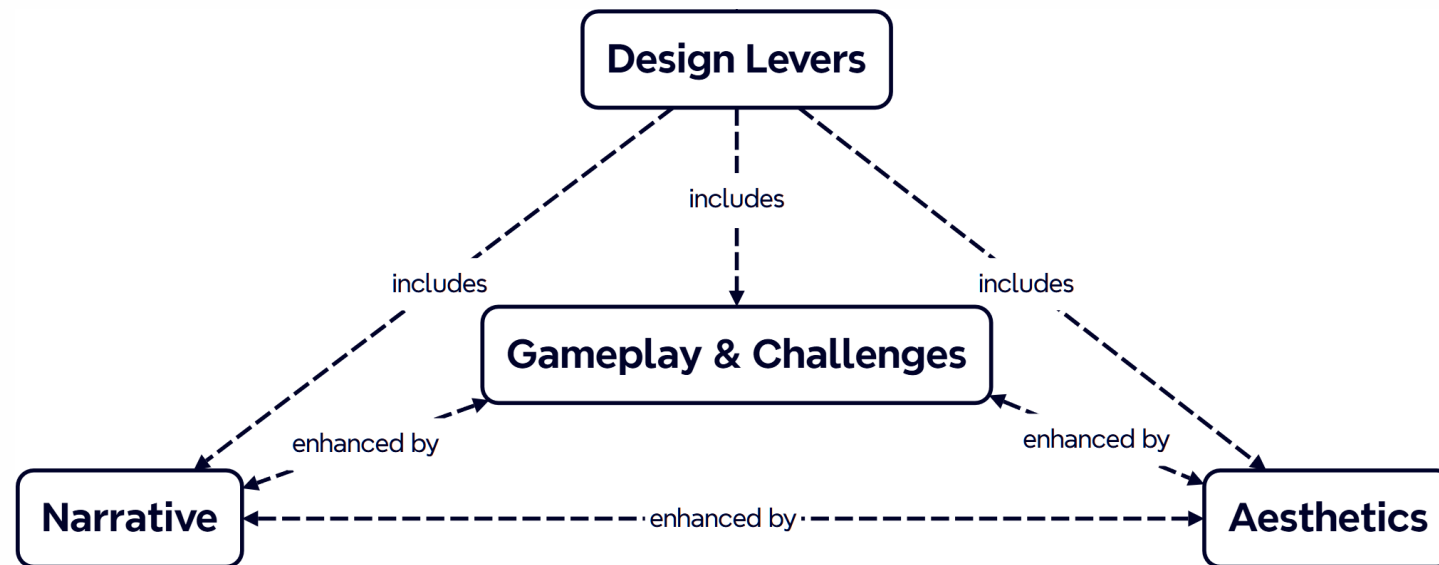
The game gives you just enough —
your mind fills the rest



How Did the Designers Do That?



How Did the Designers Do That?



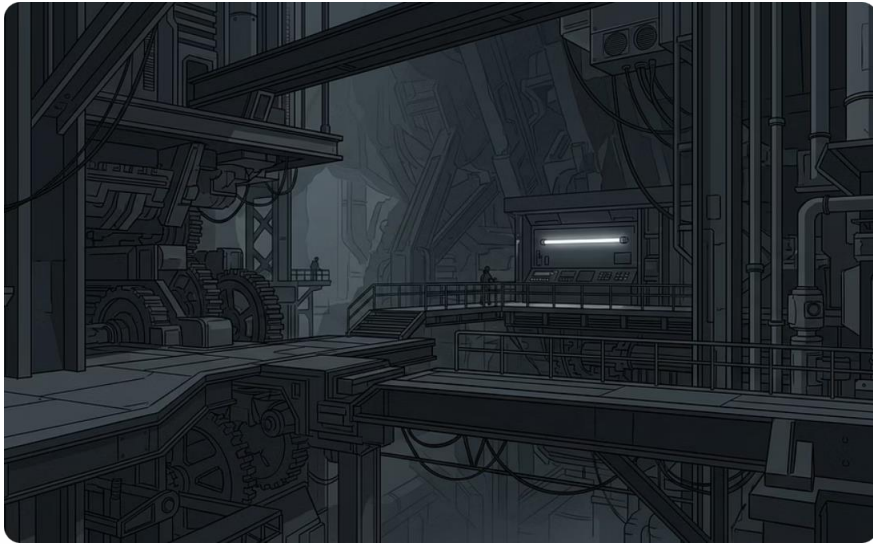
Design Levers

Designers don't control your emotions directly.
They **set the conditions** for resonance.

The player's own imagination and memory do the rest.
That gap between design and feeling is where magic lives.

Design Levers

How Did Designers Make You Feel That?



Lighting — or the Lack of It

Removing the light removes your agency.
Darkness is a design lever.

Every detail is intentional.

Design levers make resonance and imagination possible.



Enemy Placement

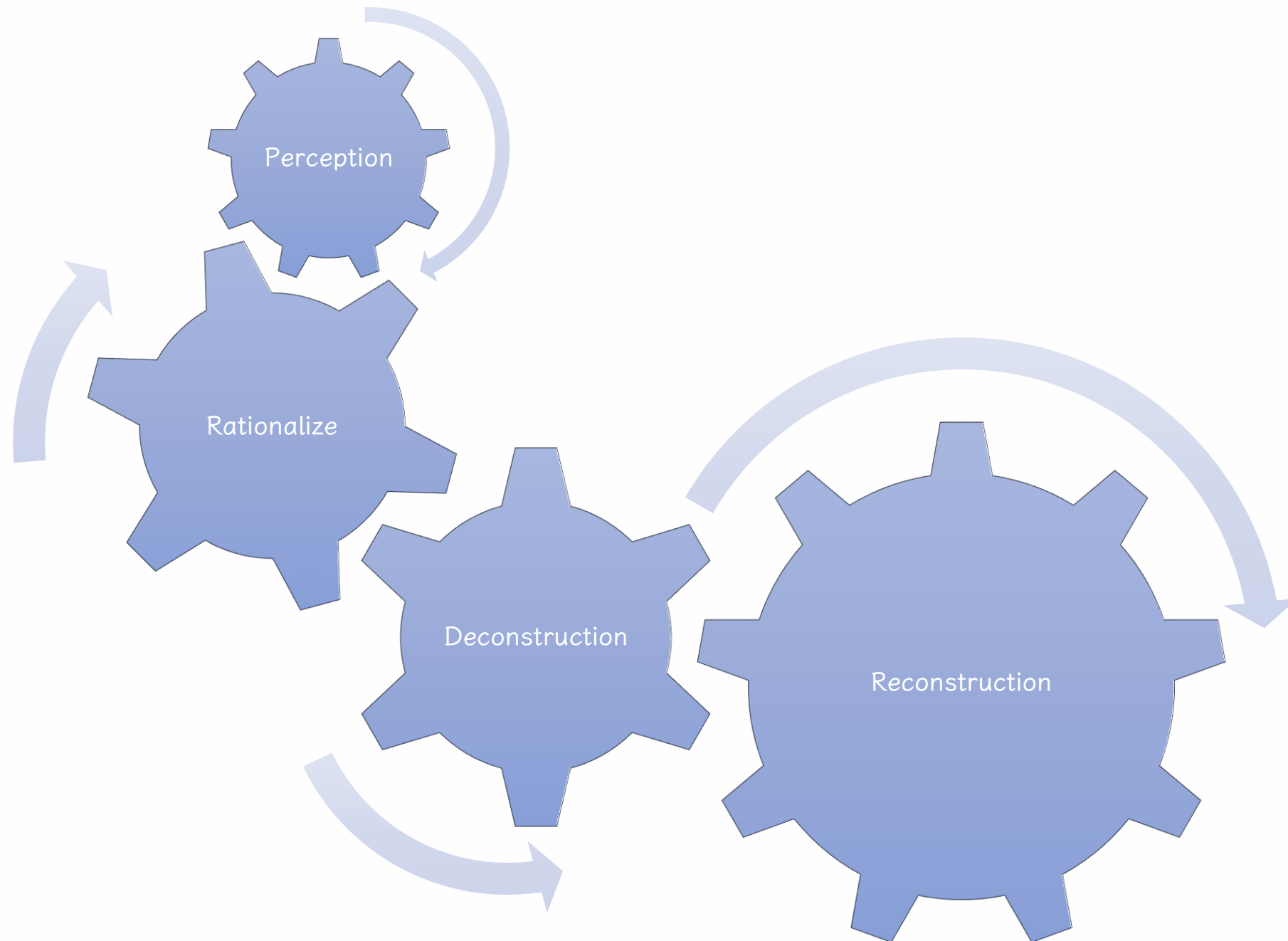
Giants in the dark.
Surprise amplifies vulnerability.



Level Geometry

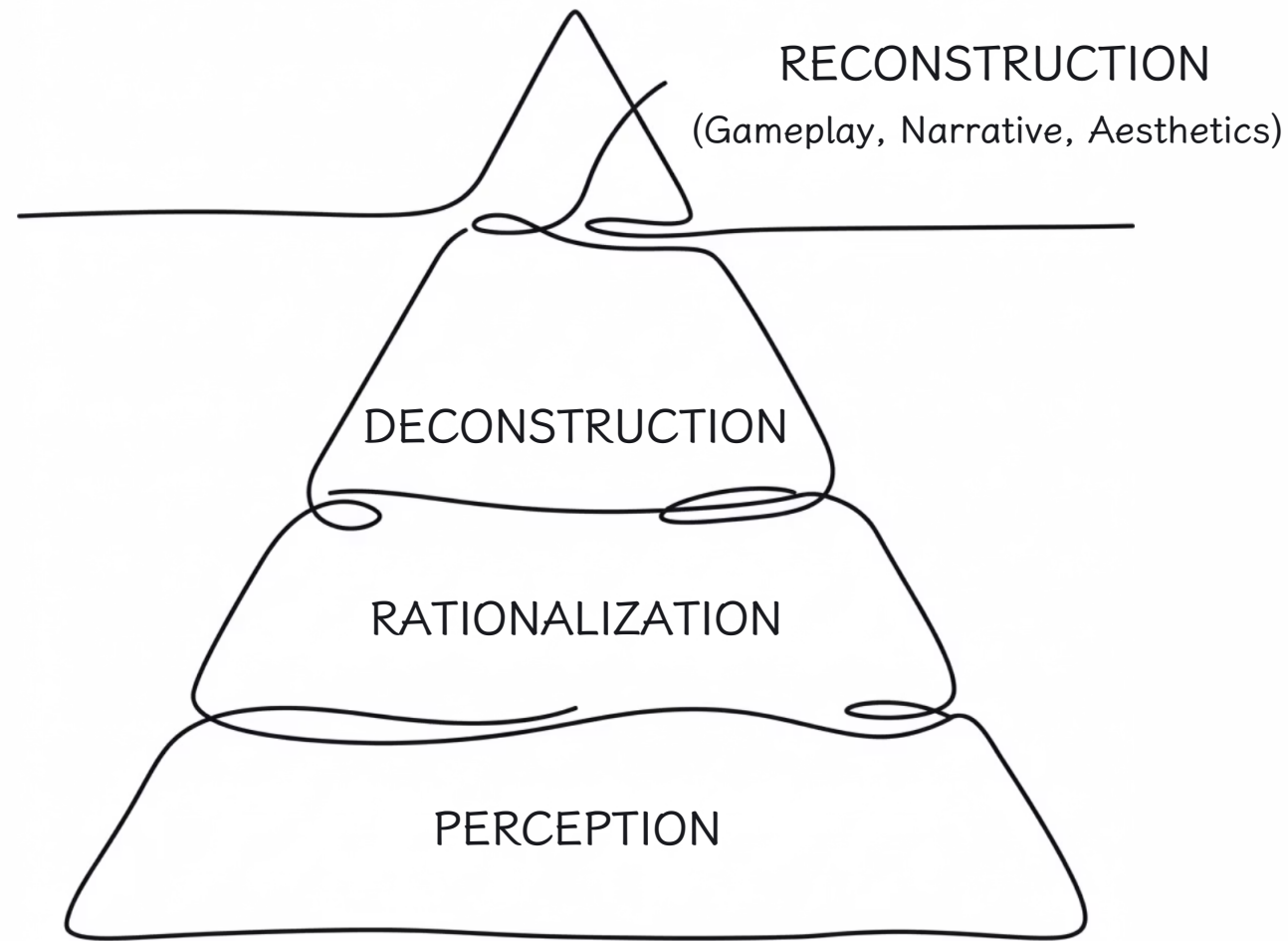
Narrow paths, invisible edges.
The space itself becomes the threat.

The Process of Experience Design



A Common Misconception

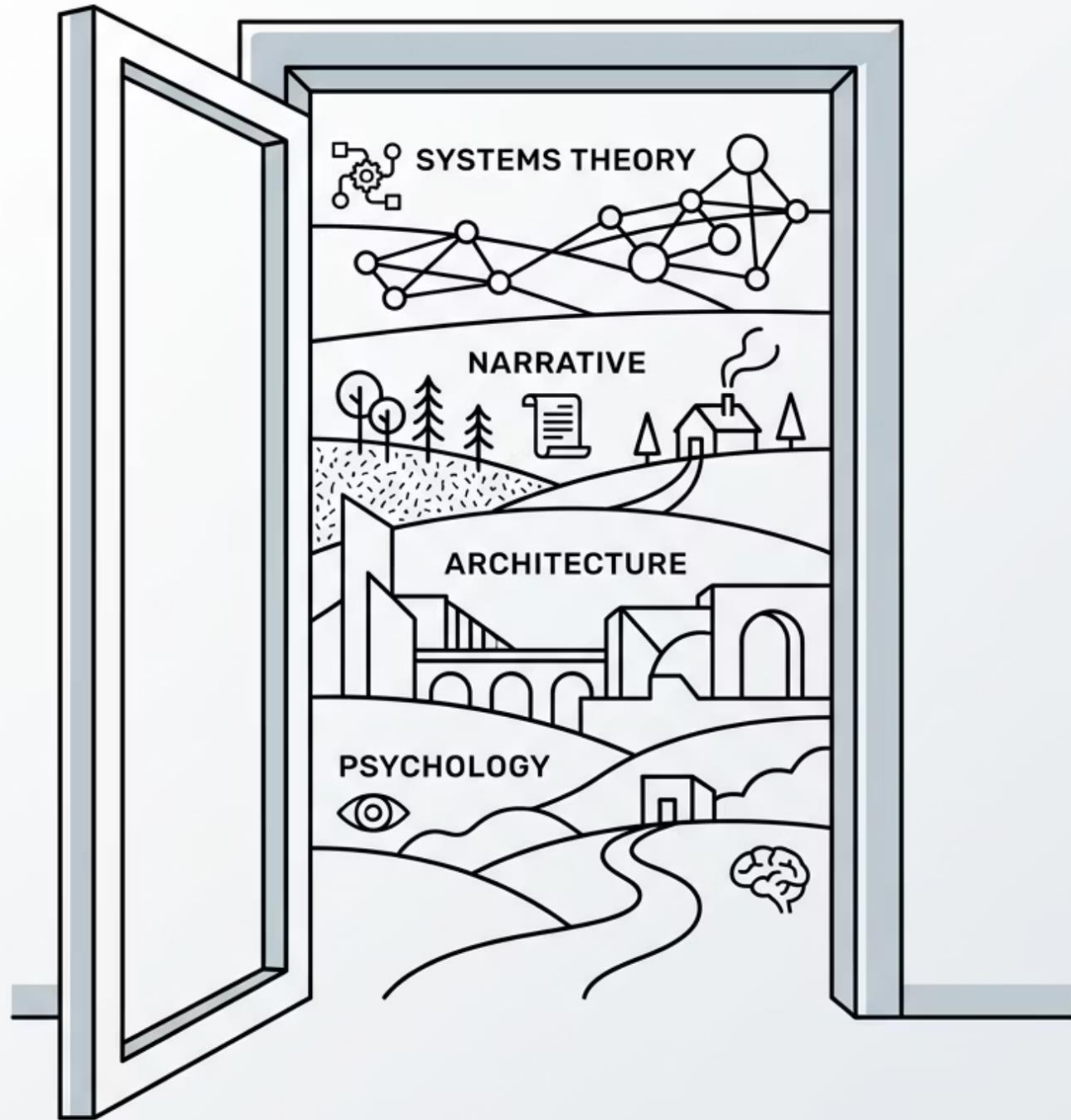
Game Design $\neq$ Just the Mechanics



What people usually call "game design"

- Gameplay, Narrative, Aesthetics
- is mostly **reconstruction**.

□ We can go much deeper on this in future discussions.
(if we have chance 😊)



There's More to Explore

We've only scratched the surface.

If there's chance, we can go deeper in future

❏ Consider this a door, not a destination.

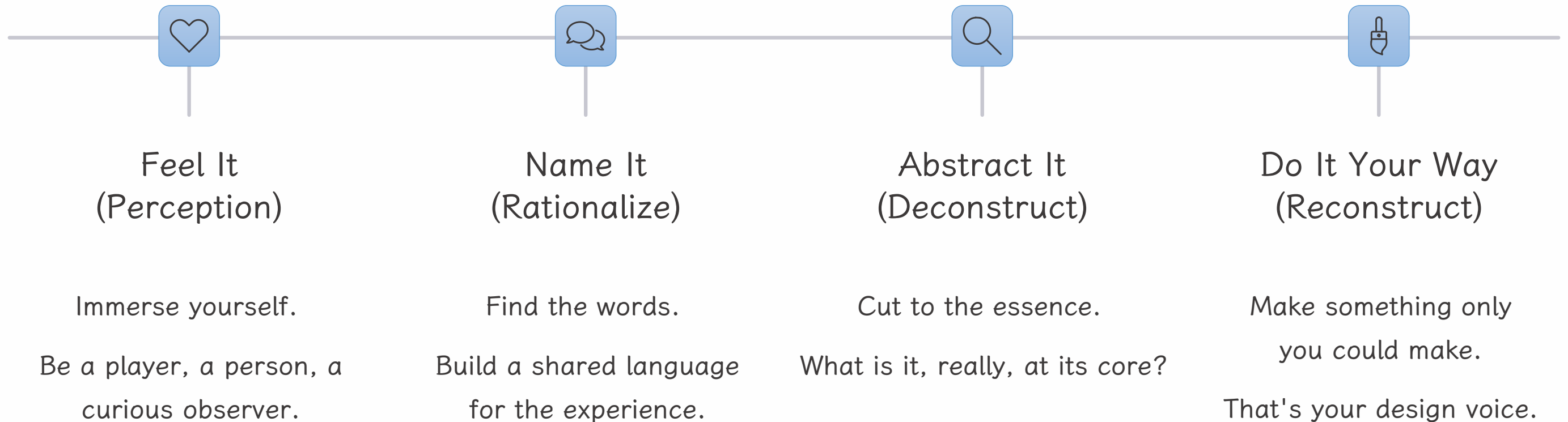


One Question to Carry With You

What experience do you want players to
feel, remember, and share?

DO NOT FORGET TO ASK YOURSELF **WHY**

Your Design Compass



Thank you for your thoughts!

Q&A



Feedback



Website